

6.3.24 Script

A computer script is exactly the same as the source code of programs, but with one important exception. Application source code is generally compiled before it is executed; a script, however, does not need to be compiled, and can be directly executed by the scripting engine. There are many scripts like PHP, ASP, JSP, DOS, VBScript, AppleScript, and so on. Each script has a corresponding scripting engine capable of reading and executing the instructions in the script. See also Batch file.

6.3.25 Source Code

All programs are written in one or the other programming language. The lines of text that comprise the program is known as the source code. The source code (or source as it is usually called) can run into tens of lines or into millions of lines. It contains variable declarations, functions, loops, instructions, and other statements that define the functioning of the program. Programmers often add “comments” to their source to ensure that they and other people who look at the source will be able to read it easier than having to spend hours trying to decipher what exactly the algorithm does. A program will usually have many source code files, which can run into even thousands depending on the complexity of the program. For the program to run on a computer, the source code needs to be compiled so that it will be in a language that the computer can understand. If any changes are made to the source code, it will need to be recompiled for those changes to be incorporated in the program.

6.3.26 String

A commonly-used data type, strings are used to represent text rather than numbers. A string is made of a group of characters which can include, text, spaces, numbers, and symbols. Even numbers can be treated as strings if the correct syntax is used. Typically, strings are enclosed in double quotes to distinguish it from variables. Thus Data1 will be treated as a variable, while “Data1” will be treated as a string.